

English SP

Terra-cotta Warriors, in Color

Open-ended questions

TODAY'S lesson

10 Vocabulary items

**9 Open-ended questions
(12 marks)**

Key vocabulary: match the meanings

1 **spectacle** Line 1

2 **buried** Line 2

3 **emperor** Line 3

4 **archaeologists** Line 3

5 **fragments** Line 22

6 **warriors** Line 28

7 **grandiose** Line 36

8 **serendipity** Line 62

9 **excavation** Line 65

10 **remnants** Line 91

C

A. A king who rules a large country (an empire).

E

B. Small broken pieces of something.

A

C. An exciting show or scene that you watch.

J

D. Digging in the ground to find old things.

B

E. Put underground; covered with earth.

I

F. Small parts that are left over; remains.

H

G. Good luck; finding something good by chance.

G

H. Very grand and impressive; bigger than necessary.

D

I. Soldiers who fight in battles.

F

J. Scientists who study old things found in the ground.

What helps you gain the mark?

Hunting for reasons, purposes & intentions

1 Easy to spot

because · since · as · due to · thanks to
so that · to + verb · in order to

e.g. The paint flaked off because the air was dry.

2 Easy to **miss** — watch out!

given + noun · with + noun · out of +
noun

prompted by · driven by · in an
attempt to

so as to · for fear of · in response to

Punctuation clues — read to the **RIGHT** of the mark

— : “ ” () ; → the reason / explanation follows the mark

Finding the purpose — demo 1

(demo — not from the examination paper)

Every day, Hong Kong restaurants throw away hundreds of tonnes of edible food. To fight this waste, a charity has launched a ‘surprise meal’ scheme: chefs collect leftover ingredients and turn them into three-course dinners sold for a sixth of the normal price — the aim is simple, to keep good food out of the landfill. ‘We are not a soup kitchen,’ says founder Grace Lam. ‘We are a rescue team.’

Customers pay what they can, and anyone who cannot pay eats for free.

Question: What is the purpose of the ‘surprise meal’ scheme?

Model answer: To keep good food out of the landfill / to reduce the amount of edible food being wasted.

Finding the reason — demo 2

(demo — not from the examination paper)

Every summer, the city's Maritime Museum hosts a model-ship race for children. Families crowd the harbour wall to watch the race, which lasts only ten minutes — the real goal is to draw young visitors into the exhibition halls. Visitors who race a boat usually beg their parents for a second visit; given the museum's modest entrance fee, few families refuse.

Question: According to the paragraph, why do families accept a second visit to the museum?

Model answer: Because the museum's entrance fee is low / modest.

// Because of the museum's modest entrance fee

Clues: 'given + noun' is an easy-to-miss reason signal. Read the second half after the semicolon: 'given the museum's modest entrance fee, few families refuse.' (REASON → answer gives the CAUSE)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

1. What does 'the task' (line 23) refer to?

transform(ing) a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warriors

20 [3] It usually takes Yang and her co-workers many days to transform a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warrior, but today they are lucky, accomplishing the task in a matter of hours. Yang has been solving such puzzles since

Evidence & explanation

'the task' looks back at the sentence before it.

(1 mark · 70%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

2. According to paragraph 3, what were the farmers doing when they first discovered the terra-cotta warriors?

(they were) digging a well (for their orchard)

hours. Yang has been solving such puzzles since
25 1974, when farmers from her village of Xiyang
first unearthed pottery and a sculpted head while
digging a well for their orchard. Having helped

(1 mark · 47%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

3. Find a word in paragraph 4 that means ‘not colorful’.

monochrome

[4] The monochrome figures that visitors to Xian’s terra-cotta army museum see today
35 actually began as the multicolored fantasy of a ruler whose grandiose ambitions extended beyond the mortal realm. The first emperor to unify China under a single dynasty Qin Shi

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 4 (line 33): “The monochrome figures that visitors to Xian’s terra-cotta army museum see today...” — **mono** = one, **chrome** = colour.

(1 mark · 37%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

4. According to paragraph 5, why did the colors of the warriors not survive?

Because of the exposure to air //

Because the colours were exposed to air

...red and green, purple and yellow.
Sadly, most of the colors did not survive the crucible of time — or the exposure to air that comes with discovery and excavation. In earlier
55 digs, archaeologists often watched helplessly as the warriors' colors disintegrated in the dry Xian air. One study showed that once exposed,

(1 mark · 83%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

5. In line 61, the writer mentions boiling an egg to show...

**Vibrant pieces of history is lost in a
short time/the paint
begins
to curl/flake off**

60 Xian air. One study showed that once exposed,
the lacquer underneath the paint begins to curl
after 15 seconds and flake off in just four
minutes – vibrant pieces of history lost in the
time it takes to boil an egg.

Evidence & explanation

Lines 58–61: "...the lacquer
underneath the paint begins to
curl after **15 seconds** and flake off
in just four minutes

(1 mark · 38%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

6. Who developed PEG (line 76)?

Chinese researchers and (experts from) the Conservation Office in Germany

75 [7] Almost thirty years ago, Chinese researchers started working with experts from the Conservation Office in Germany to develop a preservative known as PEG to help save the warriors' colors. During a recent excavation, the moment a painted artifact was unearthed, workers sprayed any bit of exposed color with the solution, then wrapped it in plastic to keep in
80 the protective moisture. The most colorful pieces (and the earth surrounding them) have been removed to an on-site laboratory for further treatment. To everyone's delight, the
85 modern techniques for preserving ancient colors seem to be working.

Evidence & explanation

both groups; naming one side loses the mark.

(1 mark · 40%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

7. What is the purpose of wrapping the artifact in plastic?

To keep in the protective moisture

80 warriors' colors. During a recent excavation moment a painted artifact was uncovered. Workers sprayed any bit of exposed color with the solution, then wrapped it in plastic to keep in the protective moisture. The most delicate pieces (and the earth surrounding them) have been removed to an on-site laboratory.

Evidence & explanation

purpose answers start with 'to...' / 'so that...'.

(1 mark · 74%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

8. According to Rong Bo, why should the earth be treated like an artifact (lines 112-113)?

(Because) so much colour and artistry is imprinted on the soil
Because of

[10] With so much color and artistry imprinted on the soil – the ancient paint, alas, adheres to dirt more readily than to lacquer – Chinese preservationists are now trying to preserve the earth itself. ‘We are treating the earth as an artifact,’ says Rong Bo, the museum’s head chemist, who helped develop a binding agent that holds the soil together so the color won’t be lost. The next challenge, Rong says, will be to find an acceptable method for reapplying this color to the warriors.

(1 mark · 28% — hardest in this lesson)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

9. Use ONE word to complete each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct, paying attention to word form, plurals, etc.

The next challenge for (i) _____ is to (ii) _____ a binding agent (iii) _____ now that a (iv) _____ together the soil.

earth as an artifact,' says Rong Bo, the museum's head chemist, who helped develop a binding agent that holds the soil together so the color won't be lost. The next challenge, Rong says, will be to find an acceptable method for reapplying this color to the warriors.

(i) 47% · (ii) 62% · (iii) 63% ·
(iv) 63%